



SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

John Gloster: Indian sports in global spotlight

It is the age of glory for Indian sports, Rajasthan Royals head physio John Gloster (centre) observed at the PlayCom 2025: Business of Sports Summit.

"We're very much on the global focus because of the IPL. It has now become the most valuable sporting property in the world.

"The whole world, particularly the US, is asking, 'What is this IPL?' The other thing that's firmly put us on the global map is we've firmly put our hand up for the 2036 Olympics," said Gloster in a session titled 'Beyond the Game: Building Careers in Sports', alongside Nilesch Kulkarni (left), Founder- Director of the International Institute of Sports & Management, Dr. Amit Bhalla (second left), Vice President, Manav Rachna University,

and Dr. Shobhit Jain IRS (second right), Joint Secretary, Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports, Government of India. The session was moderated by Varghese K George, Resident Editor, *The Hindu*, New Delhi.

Kulkarni underlined key areas India needs to focus on to accelerate sports development.

"One, obviously, is the grassroots development. That's where the talent needs to come up. And in that space, you require hundreds and thousands of people to create that filter process for a talent to grow. But you need the right person to identify that talent."

Bhalla highlighted the role of educational institutions in broadening the sports base.

"I first tried playing golf when I was 20, and my son tried golf when he

was six. Because his school had that option for him, where he could try. So educational institutions play a vital role in broadening the base. Then, if you bring in some flexibility. It should not be either or. What we need to work on is to put education and sports together."

Meanwhile, Jain explained how a shift in sporting culture has been reflected in the government's refurbished sports policy.

"Earlier, the policy was largely about medals. Today, we structured it into five verticals and one whole vertical is devoted to the economy of sports. So, this whole shift is enabling the shift in the sporting ecosystem also. Today, when we talk of careers, you add sport to any career, and there is a career".